

The fork remembers who visited.



Little draws the head before a vein fork, then after it on the same leaf vein. The two marks are evidence — clues that can support an idea. "It passed the fork!" That idea is an inference: an idea drawn from evidence.

Hold still. Then steal a step.



The prolegs anchor the rear: they hold it in place. The front stretches ahead as the body straightens. When the front grips again, the rear can follow. One end holds; the other moves. Loop by loop, the leaf gets shorter.

Middle of the road: no feet on duty.



Front grips hold the leaf. The rear slides closer and the long middle lifts into a tall loop. Soft grips near the rear are prolegs — fleshy holders, not jointed walking legs. "No walking legs under that middle," Little says.

Bridges this small skip the toll.



Little spots a green arch on the leaf. "A tiny bridge!" The arch flattens, and a small head reaches past a vein. Big watches from the path. Bending is how this caterpillar starts a trip across the same leaf vein.

WONDER TOGETHER / DAILY

A loop goes somewhere.

A loop goes somewhere



One leaf. Six steps. A story that keeps going.

GRADE 2

Past — the leaf is the map.

Pictures are simplified and not to scale. Look closely, wonder, and pause whenever you like.
Fold once. Gigggle once.

1. Print one-sided: US Letter, portrait, actual size / 100%. No fit. Headers/footers off.
2. Fold long edge to long edge; reopen. Fold short edge to short edge, then in half again. Open: eight boxes.
3. Cut only the solid center line across the middle two boxes. Keep the outer boxes joined.
4. Refold long edge to long edge, print outside. Push ends together to open a diamond, then a cross.
5. Wrap into a book with page 1 in front. Follow pages 1 to 8.

Make a little book.



Little imagines later chapters. The caterpillar becomes a pupa, then a moth. That change of body form is metamorphosis, and it takes time. "A new shape after all those loops," Little grins.

Ploof twist: wings later.

Pretend millimeters still add up.



"Does every loop go one inch?" Little asks. The name sounds like a ruler, but real steps vary. So Little invents a pretend route with made-up distances. A model can answer a math question without turning the picture into a measuring stick.